

S01-02 - The Overturned Vendor Cart

Player text

Your steeds haul the carriage around a tight bend and stop hard. The path ahead is blocked: a vendor cart lies overturned, its fruit, vegetables, and spilled preserves scattered across the trail. Something has been feeding here. The air is wrong: sweet rot and something underneath it, coppery. From the far side of the cart, you hear wet, unhurried movement.

Public objective

Figure out what happened here and clear the road.

GM goal

Block the road with a wrecked vendor cart, let the table read the scene, and plant that the obvious animal story does not add up.

GM notes

- Use the wreck as an investigation scene first and a creature reveal second.
- Player-safe language: body, feeding, blade wound. GM-only truth: staged murder and later Bramble connection.

GM script

Say: "The carriage stops hard. Ahead of you is a wreck, a body, and something feeding just out of sight. You can rush toward the sound, but you have time to look first. What do you check?" If someone checks the body, say: "The feeding is messy, but the killing wound is clean. This was not done by claws." If they need the roll, call Knowledge or Instinct, Difficulty 12.

State controls

- `slitThroatDiscovered` Slit throat discovered checkbox Carry this forward as the first crack in the animal-attack story.
- `brambleSeedFound` Bramble seed found checkbox Use only as a seed; do not resolve the later faction connection in Act 1.

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